UNIVERSITY AT ALBANY
STATE UNIVERSITY OF NEW YORK

Massry School of Business
1400 Washington Ave
Albany, NY 12222
albany.edu/business

from opportunity to impact

BFOR 621 (8220) - Forensic Laboratory Operations Management
Online Course – 3 Credit Hours
Spring 2026

Instructor: **Fabio R. Auffant II**, Lecturer
Email: fauffant@albany.edu
Office Location: **BB335 and Via Zoom**
Office Hours: As posted in *BrightSpace*
No required textbook – course materials to be posted via *BrightSpace*

COURSE DESCRIPTION

This course will cover topics of temporal or special interest in Digital Forensics, which will not be made a curricular requirement for a degree. The topics of interest will be based on current events, emerging trends in forensic technology and policy. This course will address operations and quality management of forensic laboratories and relevant best practices and standards derived from NIST, ANAB, and other regulatory entities, as they affect digital forensics. Course provides a graduate-level foundation for engaging in forensic laboratories in private and public sectors that use best practices and standards to guide its operational and quality management.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

After completing this class, the student should be able to:

- Identify and develop specific management policies, procedures and other requirements used to operate, manage, assess, audit, and regulate forensic laboratories derived from **ISO, NIST**, and other regulatory entities.
- Identify and apply appropriate best practices and standards that comply with accreditation and regulatory requirements for laboratory personnel and external vendors, derived from **ILAC, ANSI**, other accrediting entities.
- Conduct mock audits and assessments of student-derived mock policies and procedures, to ensure compliance with relevant operational, qualify and accrediting best practices and standards, derived from **ANAB** and other entities.

Compose required documentation associated with the operation, management and assessment of laboratory operations, facilities, and its personnel.

AACSB ASSURANCE OF LEARNING

Competency 3: Students will display an advanced level of professionalism in their communications and teamwork.

Learning Objectives

- ✓ Students will display the ability to work effectively in teams and to collaborate on joint tasks (teamwork).
- ✓ Students will be able to create detailed written summaries of the methods and results of their investigations in a professional manner (written communication).
- ✓ Students will be trained to comprehend large technical documents and/or investigation reports (acumen of technical jargon).
- ✓ Students will be able to verbally present their ideas and defend the findings of their investigations and reports (oral communication).

COURSE FORMAT

Online Learning Environment: The course is offered through online delivery of coursework derived from mock scenarios and laboratory operations case studies, as directed by instructor. The instructor will guide students through this course to facilitate students' participation, research and self-reliance in finding, evaluating, and applying learned information to achieve goals and objectives associated with this course. Changes or modifications to this syllabus and coursework may be made by the instructor to ensure effective and efficient delivery of course content and learning objectives.

COURSE OUTLINE

Topics	**Activities**
International Standards Organization (**ISO**) standards	**Exercises** **Project** **Writing** **Participation**
International Laboratory Accreditation Cooperation (**ILAC**) standards	
American National Standards Institute (**ANSI**) standards	
National Institute of Standards and Technology (**NIST**) standards	
ANSI National Accreditation Board (**ANAB**) requirements	
Organization of Scientific Area Committees (**OSAC**) best practices	
Scientific Working Group on Digital Evidence (**SWGDE**) best practices	
Research in support of Lab Management and Operations	
Mock Scenarios and Laboratory Case Studies	
Quality Management of the Forensic Laboratory	
Conducting Audits, Assessments and investigations of Lab operations, facilities, and personnel	
Root Cause Analysis and Risk Management in Laboratory operations	
Reporting Quality audit, assessment and investigative findings to stakeholders	
Legal Proceedings and Regulatory Reporting Requirements	
Course Project Reporting	
Case Presentation	

COURSE ACTIVITIES

Participation: Students must engage in course activities that facilitate peer interaction and demonstrate knowledge of course subject matter.

Exercises: Students must engage in individual exercises to help reinforce student learning involving operations and quality management of forensic laboratories.

Presentations: Student must present findings of quality audit and assessment reports to the instructor and/or peers, as well as prepare presentation-related materials.

Quizzes: Students will participate in quizzes throughout the semester to assess the students' understanding and application of best practices and standards associated with laboratory operations and quality management terms and definitions.

Course Project: Student must provide deliverables designated by the instructor and present the findings in the form of written documentation and/or presentation activities.

GRADING & ASSESSMENT

Coursework Submissions: Except for lateness due to documented medical or emergency, all late submissions of required coursework may receive substantial point deductions. Unless otherwise directed by instructor, NO coursework will be accepted after two (2) days of submission due date and all coursework submissions will be made via *BrightSpace* only.

Coursework Grade Appeal: Student may appeal a posted grade for specific coursework by sending email to instructor within 2 days of the posted grade summarizing the appeal details. No grade appeals are accepted after 2 days of the grade posting.

Course Points: Students accumulate earned points for each of the course activities and instructor will assess each student's coursework utilizing course rubrics. Ensure each student reviews all feedback provided by the instructor via recorded exercise review and/or grading rubric to minimize the risk of receiving additional coursework deductions in future submissions.

Course Final Letter Grade: Final course letter grade is derived from the overall coursework grade point accumulation range. Refer to the *Point Range and Letter Grade* chart below.

Activity	Grade Percentage
Participation	30%
Exercises	30%
Quizzes	20%
Course Project	10%
Presentation	10%

Point Range	Letter Grade
96-100	A
90-95	A-
85-89	B+
80-84	B
75-79	B-
71-74	C+
66-70	C
63-65	C-
60-62	D
Below 60	E

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY

Every student has the responsibility to become familiar with the standards of academic integrity at the University. Faculty members must specify in their syllabi information about academic integrity and may refer students to this policy for more information. Nonetheless, students' claims of ignorance, unintentional error, or personal, or academic pressures cannot be excuses for violation of academic integrity. Students are responsible for familiarizing themselves with the standards and behaving accordingly, and UAlbany faculty are responsible for teaching, modeling and upholding them. Anything less undermines the worth and value of our intellectual work, and the reputation and credibility of the University at Albany degree. (Review the University's Standards of Academic Integrity Policy)

INCLUSIVE EXCELLENCE

The University at Albany is committed to providing a diverse and inclusive learning, living, and working environment that is free from inequality and discrimination, and to fostering a nurturing and vibrant community founded upon the fundamental dignity and respect of all of its members. The Massry School of Business, in turn, promotes this commitment through coursework, programming, training, mentoring and supporting the needs of students from all backgrounds. Students are encouraged to utilize the University's Office of Inclusive Excellence and the School's Committee on Inclusion, Equity, and Engagement (CIEE) to learn more about available resources. Massry School of Business students are invited and encouraged to participate in the "THIS IS BUSINESS" initiative which spotlights and celebrates our diverse student body.

John S. Levato Career Services Resources

Whether you are planning for employment or graduate school, take advantage of these School of Business state-of-the-art professional development resources (access them using your UAlbany email address: (1) VMock online resume critique system, and (2) Big Interview-interview practice system. More details are here.
The School of Business offers career service resources to business and accounting majors, if you are looking for assistance with your job or internship search, resume and/or cover letter assistance, interview preparation or any career related assistance, please email Director, Deirdre Sweeney at dsweeney@albany.edu to set up an appointment or Chris Wessell at chriswessell.com

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Basic Needs Assistance

It is difficult to succeed academically if you don't have enough to eat, a safe place to live and sleep, or are struggling with an unforeseen emergency. Knowing the resources available on your campus to help you succeed is key! If you need help meeting these or other basic needs, please seek assistance from Supplemental Support Services in

the Dean of Students Office. View the basic needs assistance offerings at https://www.albany.edu/dean-students/supplemental-support-services. While you're there, see the variety of helpful services available to you at the Dean of Students at https://www.albany.edu/dean-students. Contact information can be found on these websites.

DAISS Accommodations Information

Reasonable accommodation will be provided for students with documented physical, sensory, systemic, medical, cognitive, learning and/or mental health (psychiatric) disabilities.

If you believe you have a disability and require accommodation in this class, please register with Disability Access and Inclusion Student Services (DAISS). You can contact DAISS at daiss@albany.edu, 518-442-5501 or https://www.albany.edu/dean-students/disability. Once you have registered with DAISS, they will provide you with an accommodation letter that you can send to your instructors to receive your approved accommodation.

INSTRUCTOR'S RECOMMENDATION

I strongly encourage you to contact the instructor as soon as possible if you have any questions regarding coursework, hardships and any other information you may want to discuss. Contact instructor in person, or during Zoom office hours, or via email – do not hesitate.